

WE'RE BETTER THAN THAT

- * Blue denotes ppt slide
- * Brown denotes instructions to technician
- * Green denotes what the men are to say aloud

TEXT: 2 Timothy 3:12-17 (NKJV) *“All who desire to live godly in Christ Jesus will suffer persecution. 13 But evil men and impostors will grow worse and worse, deceiving and being deceived. 14 But you must continue in the things which you have learned and been assured of, knowing from whom you have learned them, 15 and that from childhood you have known the Holy Scriptures, which are able to make you wise for salvation through faith which is in Christ Jesus. 16 All Scripture is given by inspiration of God, and is profitable for doctrine, for reproof, for correction, for instruction in righteousness, 17 that the*

man of God may be complete, thoroughly equipped for every good work.”

INTRO: In our text, Paul is writing his second letter to his number one disciple, Timothy. In this letter he describes the conditions that would be prevalent in the last days. This is how he describes it:

- Hard times...
- Self love...
- Greed...
- Proud...
- Stuck-up...
- Rude...
- Disobedient...
- Ungrateful...
- Godless...
- Heartless...
- Hateful...
- Cruel...
- No self-control...
- No pity...

- Hate good...
- Sneaky...
- Reckless...
- Prideful...
- Pleasure lovers...

Then in verse ten, Paul say's to Timothy:
“Timothy, you know what I teach and how I live. You know what I want to do and what I believe. You have seen how patient and loving I am, and how in the past I put up with ¹¹ trouble and suffering in the cities of Antioch, Iconium, and Lystra. Yet the Lord rescued me from all those terrible troubles.”

Paul is saying that times will be tough and will get worse and worse, but listen to what he says to Timothy: ***“You must continue in the things which you have learned and been assured of.”*** In other words, the culture is going to go off the reservation but you are better than that!

Guys, 80% of the makeup of a child comes from its father. How a child sees its father is the exact prism through which they will view the Heavenly Father!

The most significant problem facing America is the absence of fathers from the home and family. According to the U.S. Census Bureau, America now leads the world in fatherless families.

According to the Fatherless Initiative In America, the following percentages of children live absent of their biological fathers: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- 35% overall...
- Black children 63%...
- White children 28%...
- Hispanic children 35%...

Gentlemen, we are better than that!

Almost 75% of American children living in a fatherless household will experience poverty before the age of eleven, compared to only 20% of those raised by two parents.

Children living in homes where fathers are absent are far more likely to be expelled from, or drop out of school. Children from fatherless homes are far more likely to:

- Develop emotional problems...
- Have behavioral problems...
- Commit suicide...
- Be neglected...
- Be abused...

Gentlemen, **we are better than that!**

Male children from a fatherless home are also far more likely to become violent criminals. As a matter of fact, **men who grew up without dads currently represent 70% of the prison population serving long-**

term sentences. Gentlemen, we are better than that!

The Wall Street Journal reported that, on the average, American parents spend less than 15 minutes a week in serious conversation with their children. Fathers spend 17 seconds a day in intimate contact with their children. The important role parents play in socializing their children and forming their character is a difficult task, but it is an impossible one if the parents fail to be present or bond with their kids.

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The University of Illinois called 2,000 homes at random between midnight and 2:00 a.m. on a Friday night in the City of Chicago to see if children knew where their parents were. In 75% of the homes called, a child answered and didn't know where the parents were.

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A father's influence cannot be measured:

- Abraham lied about Sarah being his wife...
- Isaac followed in the steps of his father and told the same lies...
- When Jacob came along they just named him liar...

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Young ladies and young men become sexually promiscuous or frigid mostly because of the influence of a father. Many are incapable of having a long-lasting meaningful relationship with anyone, least of all a spouse, because a worthless or absentee father has traumatized them!

Let me give you a Biblical example of the influence of a bad dad. Nebat is the father, and Jeroboam is the son:

- Nebat means “*He who opposes the people.*”
- Twelve times the Bible says “***Jeroboam*** (the son) ***made Israel to sin.***”
- The Bible tells us that four of Jeroboam’s (the son’s) successors “***Followed after the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat.***”
- Twenty five times the Bible refers to Jerobaom as “***The son of Nebat.***”

The Scripture is unquestionably tying the bad character of Jeroboam to his father Nebat. Nebat was either a horrible person or allowed his son to behave miserably. Either way, Nebat bore responsibility before God for what his son Jeroboam turned out to be.

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Please allow me to give you a Biblical example of a father who mentored his son into a Godly man:

- Jesse was the father of King David...
- When we are first introduced to David, his father had him assigned to a work project (tending sheep)...
- All of David's brothers were engaged in the military...
- David obediently delivered groceries to his brothers...
- David volunteered to kill the giant...
- David singlehandedly killed Goliath...
- Saul said, "*Whose son is this?*"

Gentlemen you can be big enough, and good enough, to become a Jesse! Be the kind of father that when people get to know your children that they want to meet you. May those who meet our children say, "*What kind of dad can raise a kid like this?*"

Ezekiel 22:30 (NKJV) *“I sought for a man among them who would make a wall, and stand in the gap before Me on behalf of the land, that I should not destroy it; but I found no one.”* (LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE END OF THE SERVICE)